MODULE 1

What a Character!

"Be true to yourself. Make each day a masterpiece."

— JOHN WOODEN

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What makes a character interesting?

MAIN STORIES

1	**Marisol McDonald Doesn't Match**	· Monica Brown	REALISTIC FICTION
2	**Judy Moody, Mood Martian**	· Megan McDonald	REALISTIC FICTION
3	**Stink and the Freaky Frog Freakout**	· Megan McDonald	REALISTIC FICTION
4	**Scaredy Squirrel**	· Mélanie Watt	FANTASY

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NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 1 · What a Character! · Grade 3 · 25 Items

CCSS L.3.4 · L.3.5 · L.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.3.6

individuality

Your **individuality** is —

- ○ **A.** what makes you different from everyone else.
- ○ **B.** a habit that everyone in a group shares.
- ○ **C.** a rule that makes everyone act the same.
- ○ **D.** a way to look exactly like your friends.

Q2 L.3.6

unique

Something that is **unique** is —

- ○ **A.** very common and seen everywhere.
- ○ **B.** the same as many others around it.
- ○ **C.** one of a kind — not like any other.
- ○ **D.** easy to copy or repeat.

Q3 L.3.6

feature

A **feature** of a person or thing is —

- ○ **A.** a movie that plays at night.
- ○ **B.** an important or interesting part of it.
- ○ **C.** a small flaw that should be hidden away.
- ○ **D.** the price you pay to buy it.

Q4 L.3.6

personality

Your **personality** is —

- ◯ **A.** the color of your hair and eyes.
- ◯ **B.** the clothes you wear to school.
- ◯ **C.** the size of your shoes.
- ◯ **D.** your nature — all the ways you think, feel, and act.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · MARISOL MCDONALD DOESN'T MATCH

Q5 L.3.5 TRAP

clash

"Those pants don't match that shirt! They **clash**." Here, **clash** means colors or patterns that —

- ◯ **A.** look strange or ugly together.
- ◯ **B.** make a loud sound when they hit.
- ◯ **C.** look pretty and matching side by side.
- ◯ **D.** blend together into one plain color.

Q6 L.3.4

winking

Dad answered "Maybe," smiling and **winking**. You are **winking** when you —

- ◯ **A.** close both eyes for a long sleep.
- ◯ **B.** rub your eyes because they are tired.
- ◯ **C.** quickly blink one eye to share a joke or secret.
- ◯ **D.** stare without moving at all.

Q7 L.3.4

suggest

If you **suggest** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** firmly order someone to do it.
- ◯ **B.** give an idea or plan for someone to think about.
- ◯ **C.** keep the idea a secret from everyone.
- ◯ **D.** say no to every idea you hear.

Q8 L.3.4

scrunches

When something **scrunches** up, it —

- ◯ **A.** is pulled out long and straight.
- ◯ **B.** is smoothed out flat and even.
- ◯ **C.** is stretched wide and open.
- ◯ **D.** is squeezed or crushed into a different shape.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · MARISOL MCDONALD DOESN'T MATCH (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.3.4

mushy

Something that is **mushy** is —

- ◯ **A.** soft and squishy.
- ◯ **B.** hard and sharp.
- ◯ **C.** dry and dusty.
- ◯ **D.** cold and frozen.

Q10 L.3.5 TRAP

usual

The **usual** way to do something is the way that —

- ◯ **A.** nobody has ever tried before.
- ◯ **B.** is strange and out of the ordinary.
- ◯ **C.** is done most often.
- ◯ **D.** changes every single time.

Q11 L.3.4

bilingual

Marisol speaks Spanish, English, and sometimes both. People who are **bilingual** can —

- ◯ **A.** ride two bikes at once.
- ◯ **B.** speak two languages.
- ◯ **C.** speak only one language.
- ◯ **D.** talk very fast and loud.

Q12 L.3.5 TRAP

mismatched

Marisol's puppy is **mismatched**, just like her. Things that are **mismatched** —

- **A.** make a perfect matching pair.
- **B.** are exactly the same in every way.
- **C.** were won in a sports match.
- **D.** do not fit or belong together.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · JUDY MOODY, MOOD MARTIAN

Q13 L.3.4

moody

Judy can be **moody**. If you are **moody**, your feelings —

- **A.** change often and quickly.
- **B.** stay exactly the same all year.
- **C.** are always happy, never sad.
- **D.** stay calm no matter what happens.

Q14 L.3.4

pesky

Stink buzzed in Judy's ear like a **pesky** mosquito. Something that is **pesky** is —

- **A.** calm and soothing.
- **B.** quiet and easy to ignore.
- **C.** annoying and hard to ignore.
- **D.** helpful and kind.

Q15 L.3.4

illustrate

Amy likes to dream up a story and **illustrate** it. When you **illustrate** a book, you —

- **A.** read it out loud to a class.
- **B.** draw pictures that go with the story.
- **C.** sell it at a bookstore.
- **D.** tear out all the pages.

Q16 L.3.5 TRAP

snarled

Her finger-knitting chain snaked and **snarled** out the closet door. Here, **snarled** means —

- **A.** growled angrily like a dog.
- **B.** laid out smooth and straight.
- **C.** wound into a neat ball.
- **D.** twisted and tangled.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · STINK AND THE FREAKY FROG FREAKOUT

Q17 L.3.4

annual

The Frog Count is an **annual** event. An **annual** event happens —

- **A.** once each year.
- **B.** every single hour.
- **C.** only one time ever.
- **D.** twice every day.

Q18 L.3.4

recited

Stink **recited** the frog facts he had studied. If you **recited** something, you —

- **A.** wrote it down quietly on paper.
- **B.** heard it for the very first time.
- **C.** said it aloud after you had learned it.
- **D.** read it silently to yourself.

Q19 L.3.5 TRAP

protested

"But—" Stink **protested**. If you **protested**, you —

- **A.** marched in a parade downtown.
- **B.** said why you did not agree with an idea.
- **C.** guarded a building all night.
- **D.** quietly agreed with everyone.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · SCAREDY SQUIRREL

Q20 L.3.4

venturing

Scaredy Squirrel is afraid of **venturing** out of his tree. If you are **venturing** somewhere, you are —

- ◯ **A.** staying safe in one spot.
- ◯ **B.** hurrying back to a place you know well.
- ◯ **C.** waiting quietly inside your home.
- ◯ **D.** going somewhere unfamiliar that may be unsafe.

Q21 L.3.4

predictable

Scaredy Squirrel likes his day to be **predictable**. If something is **predictable**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** just as you expect, with no surprises.
- ◯ **B.** full of sudden changes.
- ◯ **C.** surprising and impossible to guess.
- ◯ **D.** different every single day.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · SCAREDY SQUIRREL (CONTINUED)

Q22 L.3.5 TRAP

emergency

Scaredy Squirrel keeps an **emergency** kit ready. An **emergency** is —

- ◯ **A.** a slow, calm afternoon.
- ◯ **B.** an ordinary day when nothing goes wrong.
- ◯ **C.** an unexpected situation that needs quick action.
- ◯ **D.** a planned event you wait weeks for.

Q23 L.3.4

consult

Scaredy Squirrel will **consult** his plan before he moves. If you **consult** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** ignore it and guess on your own.
- ◯ **B.** look at it to find information.
- ◯ **C.** put it away without opening it.
- ◯ **D.** memorize it and never check again.

Q24 L.3.5 TRAP

distract

A loud noise can **distract** a squirrel. If you **distract** someone, you —

- **A.** help them focus harder on one thing.
- **B.** help them pay closer attention.
- **C.** remind them to keep their mind on the task.
- **D.** pull their attention away from something.

Q25 L.3.5 TRAP

drastic

After he learns to fly, Scaredy Squirrel makes **drastic** changes. If you make a **drastic** change, you —

- **A.** do something very different from what you always did.
- **B.** make one tiny change no one notices.
- **C.** keep everything exactly the same.
- **D.** go back to your old way after a while.

B Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 1 · What a Character! · Grade 3 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.3.1 · RL.3.2 · RL.3.3 · RL.3.5 · RL.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each story to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Story 1 · Marisol McDonald Doesn't Match

REALISTIC FICTION · MONICA BROWN / SARA PALACIOS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.3.1

At the START of the story, what does everyone keep telling Marisol about herself?

- ◯ **A.** That she is the fastest runner in school.
- ◯ **B.** That she doesn't match.
- ◯ **C.** That she should learn to cook.
- ◯ **D.** That she talks too quietly.

Q2 RL.3.3

Why does Marisol's cousin Tato say she "doesn't match"?

- ◯ **A.** Because she wears two different shoes.
- ◯ **B.** Because she cannot kick a soccer ball.
- ◯ **C.** Because she speaks only Spanish.
- ◯ **D.** Because her skin is brown like his, but her hair is the color of carrots.

Q3 RL.3.3

When her brother says her green polka dots and purple stripes CLASH, how does Marisol feel about them?

- ◯ **A.** She loves them and thinks they go great together.
- ◯ **B.** She is sad and changes her clothes.
- ◯ **C.** She agrees that they look strange.
- ◯ **D.** She gives them to Tato.

Q4 RL.3.3

What does it tell you about Marisol that she likes peanut butter and jelly BURRITOS and speaking two languages?

- **A.** That she is always hungry at school.
- **B.** That she does not like Spanish food.
- **C.** That she enjoys mixing two cultures into something all her own.
- **D.** That she wants to be just like Tato.

Q5 RL.3.3 TRAP

What happens when Marisol decides she WILL match for a whole day?

- **A.** She wins a prize for matching the best in class.
- **B.** Tato finally agrees to play soccer with her.
- **C.** Her teacher Ms. Apple gives her a new puppy.
- **D.** She feels unhappy and not like herself, and stops by the end of the day.

Q6 RL.3.6

This story is told by Marisol herself, using the words "I," "my," and "me." This point of view lets the reader —

- **A.** know Marisol's own feelings about not matching, in her own words.
- **B.** hear what every classmate is thinking.
- **C.** learn the thoughts of the puppy.
- **D.** see the story only through Tato's eyes.

Q7 RL.3.5 TRAP

"Marisol McDonald Doesn't Match" is REALISTIC FICTION. What makes it realistic fiction?

- **A.** A squirrel learns that it can fly, like in "Scaredy Squirrel."
- **B.** It is a list of true facts about Peru and Scotland.
- **C.** The story is made up, but a girl, a school, and a family like Marisol's could really exist.
- **D.** Animals talk and wear clothes.

Q8 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA, or message, of "Marisol McDonald Doesn't Match"?

- **A.** Everyone should try hard to match so that others are happy.
- **B.** It is better to be yourself than to try to be like everyone else.
- **C.** A puppy is the best gift a teacher can give.
- **D.** Tato is right that not matching is a problem to fix.

Story 2 · Judy Moody, Mood Martian

REALISTIC FICTION · MEGAN MCDONALD / PETER H. REYNOLDS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.3.1

Why is Judy Moody in a bad mood at the START of the story?

- ◯ **A.** She lost her cat, Mouse.
- ◯ **B.** She forgot her lunch at home.
- ◯ **C.** She had to move to a new school.
- ◯ **D.** Her school pictures came home that day and she did not like how they looked.

Q10 RL.3.3 TRAP

Why does Mr. Todd send Judy to "Antarctica"?

- ◯ **A.** "Antarctica" is the chill-out desk at the back of the room, and Judy keeps jumping up instead of doing her work.
- ◯ **B.** Antarctica is a country Judy is studying for class.
- ◯ **C.** Judy asked to sit by the window.
- ◯ **D.** Stink told Mr. Todd to move her.

Q11 RL.3.3

What is Judy's PLAN after her bad day?

- ◯ **A.** To run away to Frog Neck Lake.
- ◯ **B.** To try to stay in a good mood for one whole week.
- ◯ **C.** To never speak to Stink again.
- ◯ **D.** To take new school pictures by herself.

Q12 RL.3.3

Why does Judy go to study Jessica "A-plus" Finch?

- ◯ **A.** Because Jessica owns a finger-knitting kit.
- ◯ **B.** Because Jessica is her little sister.
- ◯ **C.** Because "Little Miss Perfect" always seems happy, and Judy wants to learn how to be in a good mood.
- ◯ **D.** Because Jessica lost her own pictures too.

Q13 RL.3.3

As Judy tries to stay in a good mood, what does the reader learn is HARD for her?

- ◯ **A.** Riding her bike to Jessica's house.
- ◯ **B.** Finding her cat, Mouse, in the house.
- ◯ **C.** Staying cheerful is harder than it looks, and her fingers itch to do something.
- ◯ **D.** Remembering the names of her friends.

Q14 RL.3.3

What does Judy being the "fastest finger knitter in Frog Neck Lake" show about her?

- ◯ **A.** That she is proud of being good at her own special thing.
- ◯ **B.** That she does not like to be busy.
- ◯ **C.** That she wants to be exactly like Jessica.
- ◯ **D.** That she dislikes making things with her hands.

Q15 RL.3.6 TRAP

The narrator often repeats "She, Judy Moody, ..." Why does the author write it this way?

- ◯ **A.** To show that there are two girls named Judy.
- ◯ **B.** To hide who the story is really about.
- ◯ **C.** To show that Stink is telling the story.
- ◯ **D.** To put the spotlight on Judy and her big, bold moods.

Q16 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA of "Judy Moody, Mood Martian"?

- ◯ **A.** School pictures are the most important part of the year.
- ◯ **B.** Changing your mood takes real effort, and everyone finds happiness in their own way.
- ◯ **C.** The best way to feel happy is to copy Jessica Finch.
- ◯ **D.** A good mood should last only one day.

Story 3 · Stink and the Freaky Frog Freakout

REALISTIC FICTION · MEGAN MCDONALD / PETER H. REYNOLDS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.3.1

What does Stink need to do before he can take part in the annual Frog Count?

- ◯ **A.** Catch ten frogs in one day.
- ◯ **B.** Study the different frogs and the sounds they make, then pass a quiz.
- ◯ **C.** Win a swimming race against Webster.
- ◯ **D.** Build a new frog pond in the yard.

Q18 RL.3.3

How does Judy decide to HELP Stink study the frog sounds?

- **A.** She reads the whole frog book out loud to him.
- **B.** She takes the quiz for him.
- **C.** She tells him to ask Mouse the cat.
- **D.** She turns it into a guessing game called "Rock, Balloon, Squeak Toy."

Q19 RL.3.3

Judy makes frog sounds with everyday objects. What does she use them FOR?

- **A.** To make sounds Stink must guess, so he learns which frog is which.
- **B.** To wake up Mom and Dad early.
- **C.** To scare Mouse out of the room.
- **D.** To play music for a band.

Q20 RL.3.3

What finally happens on the day of Stink's test?

- **A.** He decides not to take the test at all.
- **B.** He forgets every frog sound he learned.
- **C.** He passes his frog test with flying colors.
- **D.** Judy takes the test in his place.

Q21 RL.3.3

How is Judy DIFFERENT toward Stink in this story compared with "Judy Moody, Mood Martian"?

- **A.** Here she refuses to speak to him at all.
- **B.** Here she is a stranger who has never met him.
- **C.** Here she is much younger than Stink.
- **D.** Here she is patient and helpful, instead of wanting him to leave her alone.

Q22 RL.3.6 TRAP

In this story, who is the MAIN character the reader follows most closely?

- **A.** Judy, because she is the older sister.
- **B.** Mouse, the family cat.
- **C.** Stink, because the story follows his problem of learning the frog sounds.
- **D.** Webster, Stink's swim friend.

Q23 RL.3.5 TRAP

"Stink and the Freaky Frog Freakout" is REALISTIC FICTION. What makes it that?

- **A.** A boy, his sister, and a frog quiz are made up, but they could all happen in real life.
- **B.** A squirrel discovers it can glide through the air.
- **C.** It is only a set of true science facts about frogs.
- **D.** The frogs talk and give Stink advice.

Q24 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA of "Stink and the Freaky Frog Freakout"?

- **A.** Quizzes are always too hard to pass.
- **B.** With a clever idea and a little help, a hard job can become fun, and you can succeed.
- **C.** It is better to study alone than with family.
- **D.** Frogs make the best pets of all.

Story 4 · Scaredy Squirrel

FANTASY · MÉLANIE WATT · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.3.1

Why does Scaredy Squirrel stay in his nut tree at the START?

- **A.** He would rather be safe than risk venturing out into the unknown.
- **B.** He is waiting for a friend to visit.
- **C.** He has hurt his foot and cannot move.
- **D.** The tree is full of his favorite toys.

Q26 RL.3.3

What does Scaredy Squirrel keep ready in case something goes wrong?

- **A.** A map of the whole forest.
- **B.** A basket of fresh nuts.
- **C.** An emergency kit with things like a mask, a parachute, and a bandage.
- **D.** A list of his friends' names.

Q27 RL.3.3

What makes Scaredy Squirrel finally jump out of his tree?

- **A.** He decides one calm morning to go for a walk.
- **B.** A friend lifts him out of the tree.
- **C.** The tree begins to fall down.
- **D.** A killer bee appears and he jumps in a panic, knocking his kit out of the tree.

Q28 RL.3.3

What surprising thing does Scaredy Squirrel learn about himself when he falls?

- **A.** That he is afraid of heights.
- **B.** That he is a flying squirrel and can glide through the air.
- **C.** That he cannot swim.
- **D.** That he left his kit at home.

Q29 RL.3.5 TRAP

"Scaredy Squirrel" is a FANTASY. What makes it fantasy and NOT realistic fiction?

- **A.** It tells true facts about how squirrels live.
- **B.** It is about a real girl at a real school.
- **C.** A squirrel makes plans, reads charts, and worries like a person — things a real squirrel could not do.
- **D.** It has no pictures at all.

Q30 RL.3.3

After his big surprise, what DRASTIC change does Scaredy Squirrel make?

- **A.** He makes a new daily routine that includes jumping into the unknown.
- **B.** He never leaves the tree again.
- **C.** He gives away all of his nuts.
- **D.** He stops eating nuts forever.

Q31 RL.3.6 TRAP

Who tells the story of "Scaredy Squirrel"?

- **A.** Scaredy Squirrel himself, using "I" and "me."
- **B.** The killer bee.
- **C.** Marisol from the first story.
- **D.** A narrator outside the story, who uses "he" and "his" to tell about Scaredy Squirrel.

Q32 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA of "Scaredy Squirrel"?

- **A.** It is safest to stay in one place and never change.
- **B.** Don't waste your time being afraid of the unknown — taking a risk can lead you to something wonderful.
- **C.** Killer bees are the most dangerous thing in the world.
- **D.** An emergency kit can solve every problem.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 1 · What a Character! · Grade 3

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each story to think more deeply about what makes a character interesting. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Reflection DOK 3

In **"Marisol McDonald Doesn't Match,"** Marisol is HAPPY when she does not match, but UNHAPPY when she tries to match. Reflect on how her feelings change.

MARISOL · BEING HERSELF VS. MATCHING

WHEN SHE IS HERSELF (DOESN'T MATCH)	→	WHEN SHE TRIES TO MATCH

What does Marisol learn about herself by the end? Why does this make her interesting?

Q2 Perspective DOK 2

In **"Marisol McDonald Doesn't Match,"** different characters see Marisol in different ways. Show how the SAME girl looks through THREE pairs of eyes.

ONE GIRL · THREE POINTS OF VIEW

TATO · HER COUSIN	HER TEACHER MS. APPLE	MARISOL HERSELF

Whose point of view do you agree with most? Why?

Q3 Causation DOK 3

In **"Judy Moody, Mood Martian,"** one thing leads to another. Map the CHAIN of causes that puts Judy in a bad mood and then leads to her plan.

CAUSE AND EFFECT · JUDY'S DAY

Judy's Mood

CAUSE · WHAT CAME HOME THAT DAY?

EFFECT · WHAT DID JUDY DO IN CLASS?

THEN · WHERE DID MR. TODD SEND HER?

FINALLY · WHAT PLAN DID JUDY MAKE?

Which cause mattered MOST in changing Judy's mood? Explain your thinking.

Q4 Causation DOK 3

In **"Scaredy Squirrel,"** one surprise leads to a big change. Trace THREE steps that turn a scared squirrel into a brave one.

THREE STEPS · FROM SCARED TO BRAVE

STEP 1 · THE BEE

what appears and makes Scaredy Squirrel panic?

STEP 2 · THE FALL

what does he discover about himself as he falls?

STEP 3 · THE CHANGE

what drastic change does he make to his routine?

Which step changes Scaredy Squirrel the most? Why does it matter?

Q5 Connection DOK 4

Essential Question: What makes a character interesting? Use ideas from TWO of the characters in this module to answer.

TWO-CHARACTER SYNTHESIS

CHARACTER 1 · NAME & STORY

What is one thing this character does that makes them interesting?

CHARACTER 2 · NAME & STORY

What is one thing this character does that makes them interesting?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 1 · What a Character! · Grade 3

MAP RIT 195 → 215 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the stories in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Boy Who Drew on Everything

Dev was a boy who drew on everything. He drew dinosaurs on his homework, robots on his lunch bag, and tiny dragons in the corners of his math book. His teacher, Mr. Park, was not sure what to think. "Dev, you must stop drawing during class," he said one morning. Dev looked down. He did not want to be in trouble. But drawing was the most interesting part of his day. The next week, the class had to make posters about rainforests. Dev's poster was covered with bright frogs, curling vines, and a sky full of birds. The whole class gathered around it. Even Mr. Park smiled. "Dev," he said, "your drawing is a gift. Let's find the right time for it." From then on, Dev had a special drawing notebook. He still listened in class. But at the end of each lesson, he could fill a page with anything he imagined. His pictures made the whole class want to draw too.

162 WORDS · LEXILE 420–470L · RIT 195–201

Q1 RIT 195 | Lexile 420L | Key Detail

What does Dev like to draw on?

- ◯ **A.** Everything — his homework, his lunch bag, and his math book.
- ◯ **B.** Only the classroom wall.
- ◯ **C.** A large canvas at home.
- ◯ **D.** Nothing at all.

Q2 RIT 197 | Lexile 430L | Cause & Effect

Why does Mr. Park first tell Dev to stop drawing?

- ◯ **A.** Because Dev has run out of paper.
- ◯ **B.** Because the other students complain.
- ◯ **C.** Because Dev is drawing during class instead of doing his work.
- ◯ **D.** Because the drawings are not good.

Q3 RIT 199 · Lexile 450L · Inference

What MOST likely makes Mr. Park change his mind about Dev's drawing?

- ◯ **A.** Dev promises never to draw again.
- ◯ **B.** Dev's rainforest poster is so good that the whole class gathers around it.
- ◯ **C.** Dev's parents come to the school.
- ◯ **D.** Dev wins money in a contest.

Q4 RIT 200 · Lexile 460L · Vocabulary

The passage says Dev's drawing "is a gift." Here, the word **gift** most likely means —

- ◯ **A.** a special talent he was born with.
- ◯ **B.** a present wrapped in paper.
- ◯ **C.** a kind of prize at a party.
- ◯ **D.** a card sent in the mail.

Q5 RIT 201 · Lexile 470L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Boy Who Drew on Everything"?

- ◯ **A.** Drawing in class is always wrong.
- ◯ **B.** Teachers should never let students draw.
- ◯ **C.** Posters are the best way to learn.
- ◯ **D.** A special talent can become a gift when there is a right time and place to use it.

Passage 2 · Mia's Loud Idea

Mia was the quietest girl in the third grade. She almost never raised her hand. When the teacher asked a question, Mia knew the answer, but the words stayed stuck inside her. Some children thought she had nothing to say. They were wrong. Mia had a head full of big ideas. One day, the class had a problem. The school garden was full of weeds, and no one knew how to fix it. The loud children argued. The fast children gave up. Then Mia did something brave. She walked to the front and unrolled a careful plan she had drawn at home. It showed which weeds to pull, where to plant seeds, and how to share the work. The room went silent. "That," said the teacher, "is a wonderful plan." Mia smiled a small, sure smile. She had learned that being quiet did not mean being empty. Sometimes the quietest person in the room has the loudest idea of all.

160 WORDS · LEXILE 480–530L · RIT 202–207

Q6 RIT 202 · Lexile 480L · Key Detail

How is Mia described at the start of the passage?

- ◯ **A.** As the quietest girl in the third grade.
- ◯ **B.** As the loudest girl in school.
- ◯ **C.** As the fastest runner in class.
- ◯ **D.** As the tallest student in the room.

Q7 RIT 204 | Lexile 490L | Cause & Effect

Why do some children think Mia has nothing to say?

- **A.** Because she does not know the answers.
- **B.** Because she almost never raises her hand or speaks up.
- **C.** Because she is new to the school.
- **D.** Because she does not like the garden.

Q8 RIT 205 | Lexile 500L | Inference

What can the reader tell about Mia from the careful plan she unrolls?

- **A.** That she does not care about the garden.
- **B.** That she copied the plan from a friend.
- **C.** That she had been thinking hard about the problem, even though she was quiet.
- **D.** That she made the plan in one minute.

Q9 RIT 206 | Lexile 510L | Vocabulary

The passage says "the quietest person in the room has the loudest idea." Here, a **loud** idea means an idea that is —

- **A.** shouted across the room.
- **B.** noisy and hard to hear.
- **C.** played on a speaker.
- **D.** big, strong, and full of meaning.

Q10 RIT 207 | Lexile 530L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Mia's Loud Idea"?

- **A.** Only loud children can solve problems.
- **B.** Gardens are too hard to fix.
- **C.** A quiet person can still have big, important ideas worth sharing.
- **D.** It is best to argue until someone gives up.

Passage 3 · The Cat Who Wanted to Bark

Pepper was not like other cats. While the other cats meowed and napped in the sun, Pepper wanted to BARK. He had grown up next to a friendly dog named Biscuit, and he thought barking was the most wonderful sound in the world. The other cats laughed at him. "Cats do not bark," they said. "You are strange." But Pepper did not mind. Each morning he practiced. "Rrruff!" it came out as a funny squeak. He kept trying anyway. One afternoon, a lost puppy wandered into the yard, crying for help. The cats did not know what to do. The puppy could not understand their meows. Then Pepper stepped forward. "Rruff! Rruff!" he called, as best he could. The puppy's ears lifted. It understood! Pepper led the little dog all the way home. After that, the other cats stopped laughing. Being different, they saw, was not strange at all. Sometimes the strangest thing about you turns out to be the most useful.

162 WORDS · LEXILE 540–600L · RIT 208–212

Q11 RIT 208 · Lexile 540L · Key Detail

What does Pepper want to do that other cats do not?

- **A.** Climb the tallest tree.
- **B.** Bark like a dog.
- **C.** Sleep all day in the sun.
- **D.** Swim in the pond.

Q12 RIT 209 · Lexile 560L · Cause & Effect

Why does Pepper want to bark in the first place?

- **A.** He grew up next to a dog named Biscuit and loved the sound.
- **B.** The other cats told him to.
- **C.** He could not meow at all.
- **D.** He wanted to scare the birds.

Q13 RIT 210 · Lexile 570L · Inference

Why is Pepper able to help the lost puppy when the other cats cannot?

- **A.** Because he is the biggest cat.
- **B.** Because he can bark, so the puppy understands him.
- **C.** Because he knows where every house is.
- **D.** Because the other cats are asleep.

Q14 RIT 211 · Lexile 580L · Vocabulary

At first the other cats call Pepper "strange." As it is used here, **strange** most nearly means —

- **A.** ordinary and just like the rest.
- **B.** friendly and well-liked.
- **C.** quiet and shy.
- **D.** unusual — not like the others.

Q15 RIT 212 · Lexile 600L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Cat Who Wanted to Bark"?

- **A.** Cats should never make dog sounds.
- **B.** Lost puppies always find their own way home.
- **C.** It is best to be exactly like everyone around you.
- **D.** The thing that makes you different can turn out to be the most useful part of you.

Passage 4 · Theo Tries Again

Theo wanted to join the school chess club, but he was afraid. He had only played chess twice, and both times he had lost quickly. At the first meeting, the other players seemed so sure of themselves. Theo's hands felt cold. He almost turned around and left. Then the club leader, an older girl named Reza, sat down across from him. "Everyone loses at first," she said kindly. "That is how you learn." They played a slow game. Reza showed Theo why each move mattered. He lost, but this time he understood why. Theo came back the next week, and the week after that. Little by little, he stopped losing so fast. One day, near the end of the year, Theo won his very first game. It was not against Reza, but he could see her smiling from across the room. Theo had learned that being brave does not mean never being afraid. It means trying again, even when you are.

161 WORDS · LEXILE 610–680L · RIT 213–215

Q16 RIT 213 Lexile 610L Key Detail

What does Theo want to do at the start of the passage?

- ◯ **A.** Join the school chess club.
- ◯ **B.** Win a running race.
- ◯ **C.** Learn to play the drums.
- ◯ **D.** Move to a new school.

Q17 RIT 214 Lexile 630L Cause & Effect

Why does Theo almost turn around and leave the first meeting?

- ◯ **A.** Because the room is too small.
- ◯ **B.** Because he is afraid, since the other players seem so sure of themselves.
- ◯ **C.** Because he forgot his chess set.
- ◯ **D.** Because Reza tells him to go home.

Q18 RIT 214 Lexile 650L Inference

How does Reza MOST help Theo get better at chess?

- ◯ **A.** She lets him win every game.
- ◯ **B.** She plays the games for him.
- ◯ **C.** She is kind, plays slowly, and shows him why each move matters.
- ◯ **D.** She tells him chess is not worth learning.

Q19 RIT 215 Lexile 670L Vocabulary

Reza says, "Everyone loses at first. That is how you learn." She MOST likely means that losing —

- ◯ **A.** means you should quit.
- ◯ **B.** is something to feel ashamed of.
- ◯ **C.** never happens to good players.
- ◯ **D.** can teach you how to get better.

Q20 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Theo Tries Again"?

- A. The best players never lose a game.
- B. Chess is the hardest game to learn.
- C. Being brave means trying again, even when you are still afraid.
- D. It is better not to join a club at all.